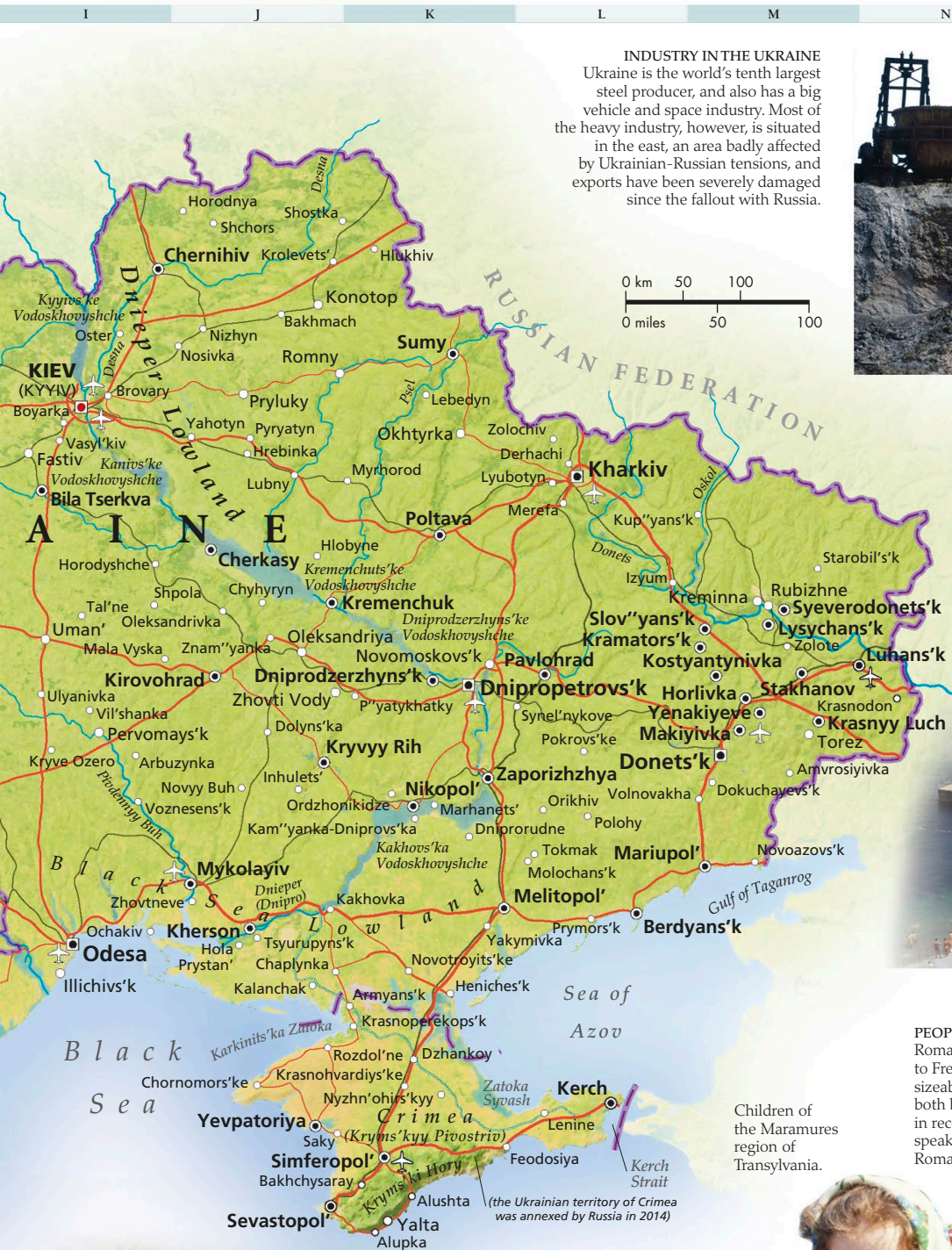


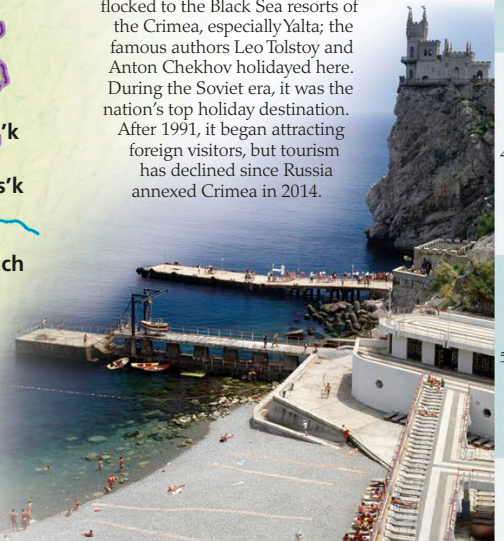


INDUSTRY IN THE UKRAINE
Ukraine is the world's tenth largest steel producer, and also has a big vehicle and space industry. Most of the heavy industry, however, is situated in the east, an area badly affected by Ukrainian-Russian tensions, and exports have been severely damaged since the fallout with Russia.



Liquid iron ore

HOLIDAYS BY THE SEA
In the days of the Russian empire, aristocracy and artists flocked to the Black Sea resorts of the Crimea, especially Yalta; the famous authors Leo Tolstoy and Anton Chekhov holidayed here. During the Soviet era, it was the nation's top holiday destination. After 1991, it began attracting foreign visitors, but tourism has declined since Russia annexed Crimea in 2014.



PEOPLE OF ROMANIA

Romanians speak Romanian—a language closely related to French, Italian, and Spanish. The country also has sizeable Hungarian and Roma minorities, which have both been discriminated against in recent years. Most Hungarian speakers live in the region of Romania known as Transylvania.

Children of the Maramures region of Transylvania.



RICH SOILS OF MOLDOVA

Moldova consists of partially wooded plains intercut with rivers and streams. About 75 percent of the land is rich in chernozem (black) soil, which is very fertile. Wine and sunflower production are important here. Fruit and vegetables, such as pumpkins (left), also grow well.

